We have this window into this world and we're still trying to understand it. We're not trying to keep it a secret, but piece the puzzle together. That's a project that is going to take time. Our intention is to release what's in the public interest but also to try to get a handle on what this world is and then try to communicate that.[5]

Reporters speculated that even the NSA did not know exactly what Snowden's massive collection of documents contained. There was also a possibility that leaks were coming from one or more other whistle-blowers and being released under Snowden's name.

OTHER NSA WHISTLE-BLOWER(S)?

Using a sophisticated searching tool, reporter James Bamford scanned all of the documents Snowden leaked. When he could not find some of the documents that had been made public, he wondered whether this pointed toward another whistle-blower—someone else with top-secret NSA access who was leaking documents under Snowden's name. More evidence for another whistle-blower came in a June 2014 article released in *Der Spiegel*. The article described how the NSA had cooperated with German intelligence. It noted that one of the documents mentioned in the article, an agreement memorandum, was not from Snowden's cache. If one or more whistle-blowers were working for the NSA and leaking documents, it would indicate the NSA had not fixed its leak problem and could not control its own information. "If that's the case," Snowden told a reporter, "how can we as the public trust the NSA with all of our information, with all of our private records, the permanent record of our lives?"[6]

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